HYBRIDS · 4 MIN READ

What a hybrid is and who it is for

A hybrid has a flat handlebar like a mountain bike and fast 700c wheels like a road bike. The rider sits upright and can see traffic. It is quicker than a mountain bike on tarmac and easier to handle than a road bike.

Two families

FAMILY	WHAT IT HAS	BEST FOR	IN OUR RANGE
Fitness hybrid	Rigid fork, lighter, tyres around 32 to 40 mm	Fitness rides, commuting, tarmac	Trek FX, Cannondale Quick, Merida Speeder, Giant Escape, Marin Fairfax, Kona Dew, Polygon Path
Dual sport	Front suspension fork, wider tyres	Mixed tarmac and rough paths	Cannondale Quick CX, Polygon Heist X

Who buys a hybrid

- Someone getting back into cycling for fitness.
- A commuter riding 5 to 20 km each way.
- A rider who wants one bike for weekday errands and weekend 30 to 40 km rides.

The most common mistake

Customers ask for a mountain bike because "the roads are bad". For city riding a hybrid with 38 to 40 mm tyres handles potholes well and is much faster and lighter. A suspension fork adds weight and needs service. At entry prices a rigid fork with wider tyres is usually the better ride. Ask where they will ride before agreeing to an MTB.

Where a hybrid stops

When a hybrid owner starts doing 50 km and longer rides regularly and wants more speed, the next step is an endurance road bike like the Domane. When they want real trails, it is a mountain bike.

Remember these

- Hybrid means flat bar, 700c wheels, upright position.
- Fitness hybrids have a rigid fork. Dual sport hybrids have a suspension fork.
- For city roads, a hybrid usually beats a mountain bike.
- Regular long, fast rides are the sign to move to an endurance road bike.